

Syd Hoeper

Senior Product Designer

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Summary

Senior Product Designer with 9 years of experience leading end-to-end product design, from discovery and user research through usability testing, launch, and post-launch iteration. Much of my work focuses on turning complex geospatial and real-time data into clear decisions people make under pressure. At Active911, I designed the maps and situational-awareness tools first responders use on live incidents, along with data visualization that made complex incident data easy to understand. I also designed interactive trip-planning maps for Trip Pilot and Campendium, including Campendium's data-rich map overlays. At Ad Hoc, I designed accessible federal services for people navigating high-stakes, often stressful situations. I align product, engineering, and senior stakeholders around clear product decisions backed by user research, usability testing, and product data.

Skills

Design Leadership: UX vision, roadmap influence, design reviews, stakeholder alignment, presenting to senior stakeholders and executives, mentoring

Product Design: End-to-end UX/UI design, rapid prototyping, information architecture, complex workflows, visual design, mobile design (native iOS and Android), responsive web

Geospatial and Data Visualization: Mapbox, Google Maps, mapping applications, map interactions, data-rich map overlays, dashboards, time-based data, waypoints, navigation

User Research and Strategy: User interviews, usability testing, personas, scenarios, Jobs-to-Be-Done, journey mapping, systems diagrams, product analytics, funnel analysis, UX metrics

Design Systems and Accessibility: Design systems, component libraries, WCAG 2.2, accessibility for government and enterprise software

Tools: Figma, Jira, Mixpanel, Claude, ChatGPT, Meshy AI, AI-assisted prototyping, Visual Studio Code, HTML, CSS, p5.js, Unity (C#), Blender

Experience

Peter Burr

Principal Experience Designer (Contract) | Remote | May 2026 - June 2026

- Defined the product vision, interaction model, and implementation strategy for an immersive mixed-reality experience, translating complex concepts into intuitive spatial interactions.
- Rapidly prototyped spatial interactions in Unity and Blender using ChatGPT and Meshy AI, collaborating across engineering, art, and production.
- Managed and mentored three NYU interns from kickoff through launch, running design reviews and check-ins and delegating production work to accelerate delivery.

Ad Hoc LLC

Senior Product Designer | Remote | November 2023 - July 2025

- Digitized a paper-based Veterans Affairs application, driving 24,000 submissions in the first two months and 76% online adoption by May 2025, and cutting per-application processing time from 17 minutes to under 5.
- Designed the VA application within the VA's enterprise design system and WCAG 2.2 standards, balancing usability, consistency, and accessibility.
- Partnered with product, engineering, research, and agency stakeholders on federal services used by hundreds of thousands of people, turning policy-heavy workflows and ambiguous requirements into shippable designs.
- Led design of a National Park Service pass-management platform, including a dashboard tracking pass issuance.
- Mapped the Social Security Administration's legacy systems through stakeholder interviews and systems diagrams, creating a shared understanding across teams.
- Synthesized Healthcare.gov usability-testing findings into prioritized improvements for future releases.

Roadpass Digital

Product Designer | Remote | December 2021 - June 2023

- Served as the lead designer for Campendium within a multi-designer team, co-owning the web and native mobile experience with the product manager while using research to inform the roadmap.
- Redesigned interactive maps and data-rich overlays that helped campers compare destinations and plan trips with confidence, future-proofing the feature and increasing free-to-paid conversion.
- Translated research into improvements that drove a 12.16% increase in users adding waypoints to trips, a key quarterly objective.
- Designed and launched Campendium's campsite-booking platform from the ground up and integrated it into the existing product, creating a new revenue stream.
- Helped define Mixpanel tracking and investigated funnel drop-off to pinpoint where users abandoned key flows.

Active911

Sole Product Designer | Remote | April 2020 - December 2021

- Owned end-to-end design for a suite of emergency-response products, including modernizing the flagship app across web and native iOS and Android.
- Launched a paid scheduling product from scratch, leading UX and visual design, to help emergency teams manage staffing and shifts, creating a new revenue stream.
- Created Mapbox and Google Maps interactions, waypoints, and navigation that gave responders situational awareness during live incidents.
- Designed an incident reporting feature that visualized map and incident data over time, turning complex information into clear, actionable insight.
- Grounded product decisions in direct customer input: interviewed first responders using Jobs-to-Be-Done, presented designs to fire chiefs, and iterated on each release with dedicated test districts.
- Established a cross-platform design system and component library that kept products consistent and sped up development.

CiES

Sole Product Designer (Contract) | Bend, Oregon | July 2018 - February 2019

- Led design of the company's first digital product, turning complex aviation fuel data and business requirements into an intuitive, production-ready application.
- Conducted user testing and iterated on the design based on the findings, partnering with the CEO and developers to gather feedback and guide product direction.

Trip Pilot

Sole Product Designer, promoted from UI/UX Design Intern | Bend, Oregon | October 2017 - April 2020

- Promoted from intern to sole product designer in six months, turning ideas and user problems into designed solutions, from research and usability testing to UX flows, prototypes, and final UI.
- Partnered closely with the CEO on product strategy and roadmap planning for a group adventure-planning app.
- Designed Mapbox-based trip planning and interactive waypoint creation that simplified collaborative planning and navigation.
- Redesigned the entire app from scratch as the company moved development in-house from a third-party vendor, creating a more cohesive experience and a more efficient build.
- Designed and launched a group checklist feature that achieved the app's highest free-to-paid conversion rate.

Education

University of Montana | Master of Fine Arts, Game Design and Interactive Media | Expected May 2028 | 4.0 GPA | Big Sky Scholarship

University of Minnesota Twin Cities | Bachelor of Science, Individualized Studies (Product Design, Cultural Anthropology, Sustainable Systems Management) | May 2017

Certifications

Figma UI/UX Design Advanced, Udemy | How to Design for Accessibility WCAG 2.2, Udemy | Design Accessibility, Uxcel | W3C Introduction to Web Accessibility, edX